

Lewis and Clark Trust Announces its Formation

A New Partnership with the National Park Service

On April 19, 2012, at the National Park Service's Midwest Regional Office, Stephenie Ambrose Tubbs and James (Jim) Mallory announced the formation of the Lewis and Clark Trust, Incorporated. The organization also announced its intention to establish administrative offices within the City of Omaha. The Lewis and Clark Trust (the Trust) was established to secure financial assets to help preserve and promote the Lewis and Clark National Historic Trail (the Trail), as administered by the National Park Service. The Trust is also in support of the eastern extension of the Trail currently under study and referred to by many as the Lewis and Clark Eastern Legacy. Through partnerships, philanthropy and education the Trust will work to preserve and promote the entire Trail, coast to coast, for future generations of Americans.

Stephenie Ambrose Tubbs, Chair of the Board for the Trust and daughter of the late historian and best-selling author Stephen Ambrose, is an accomplished researcher in her own right. She authored *The Lewis and Clark Companion: An Encyclopedic Guide to the Voyage of Discovery*, as well

as many articles on the value of engaging younger audiences in the history of the Lewis and Clark Trail. "The Trust will help secure financial assets that make all of this possible. One of my main reasons for starting the Lewis and Clark Trust is the danger I see of losing the next generation," explained Ms. Ambrose Tubbs. "We need to actively engage them [younger audiences] in the history, preservation and stewardship of the Lewis and Clark National Historic Trail or it will quietly disappear from our collective memory. We need to use every tool at our disposal to raise awareness about the Trail while placing it into the proper context so that students are continually learning the lessons the Expedition can teach us about teamwork, leadership and enlightenment science."

Trust Board member Jim Mallory commented, "A great nation deserves great historic trails that tell the story of our nation's beginning. The Lewis and Clark National Historic Trail, like the Lewis and Clark story, must be preserved for present and future generations so that the lessons of the Lewis and Clark era are not lost. Those values teach perseverance, shared

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Cover Photo and Above: Trust Board member Jim Mallory addresses the press and visitors as he announces the formation of the Lewis and Clark Trust, Inc. He is joined beginning on the far left by Mike Reynolds, NPS Midwest Regional Director; Stephenie Ambrose Tubbs, Chair of the Board; and Mark Weekley, Superintendent for Lewis and Clark National Historic Trail and staff. NPS Photo.

Lewis and Clark Trust, continued

responsibility, and the spirit of collective accomplishment, all of which still benefit our society after more than 200 years.”

National Park Service’s Midwest Regional Director, Mike Reynolds, enthusiastically welcomed the new organization. “Today’s announcement is good news for the National Park Service. We are committed to collaborations with the Lewis and Clark Trust. This relationship is a great example of how we want to work with our partners.”

“It is through partnerships like this that the National Park Service is able to more effectively administer the Lewis and Clark National Historic Trail. We are delighted to welcome this new friend into our circle of partners and are excited about the potential

of reaching younger and more diverse audiences across the 3,700 mile Trail,” said Mark Weekley, Superintendent of the Lewis and Clark National Historic Trail. “It is our privilege to join efforts with the Lewis and Clark Trust to look to the future ... and the many possibilities that lie ahead of us.”

Also speaking at the well-attended outdoor ceremony were Steve Oltmans, Chief of Staff for the Omaha Mayor’s office, and Jim Greisch, Economic Development Council Chairman for the Greater Omaha Chamber of Commerce. Each congratulated the leadership of the Lewis and Clark Trust on the successful formation of their new organization and heartily welcomed the establishment of its headquarters in the Greater Omaha area. ■

Watch the Video

Lewis and Clark Trust Press Conference

18:35 min

<http://youtu.be/JAfHXIeF1xQ>

Lewis and Clark Trust Press Conference Photos



Mike Reynolds, NPS Midwest Regional Director, speaks about the importance of partnerships.



Lewis and Clark Trust announces its formation during a press conference at the Midwest Regional Office in Omaha, Nebraska, also headquarters of the Lewis and Clark National Historic Trail.



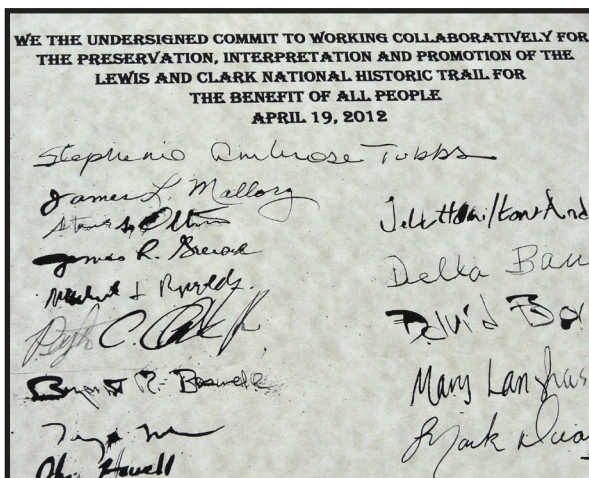
Members of the Discovery Expedition of St. Charles in formation. NPS Photo.



Students use a quill pen to sign a pledge to work together for the preservation of the L&C Trail. All in attendance were invited to sign.



From left: Bud Clark, Dan Wiley, and Rachel Daniels share stories. NPS Photo.



People lined up to show their support by signing and pledging their support. It's the beginning of a new partnership.